

Psittacula krameri

Rose-ringed parakeet



Length 16 in (40 cm)
Weight 4 oz (125 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location W. to E. Africa, S. and S.E. Asia



This slim-bodied green bird has a rose-pink collar around its hind neck. It has the widest natural distribution of any parrot, stretching from West Africa to Southeast Asia. As a feral bird, it is

Myiopsitta monachus

Monk parakeet



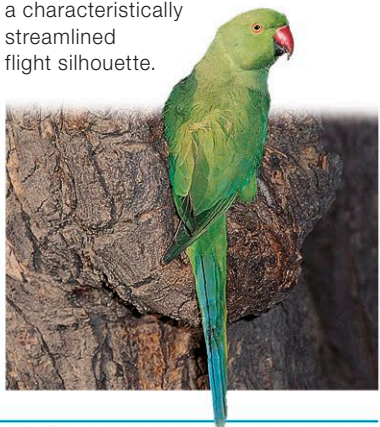
Length 11½ in (29 cm)
Weight 4 oz (125 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

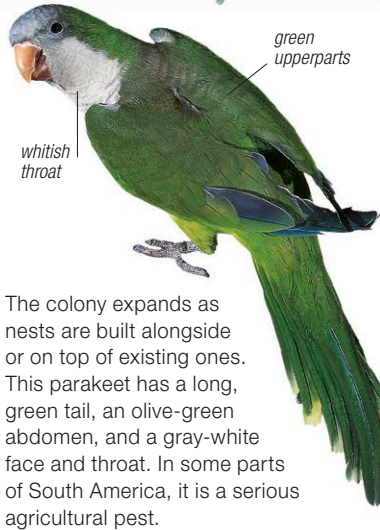
Location C. and S. South America



The nesting habits of this green parakeet are unique among parrots. With several other pairs, it roosts in a communal nest, which forms the center for the birds' daily activities.

also found in parts of Europe and North America. The central tail feathers are long and narrow, and the backward-sweeping wings produce a characteristically streamlined flight silhouette.





green upperparts
whitish throat

The colony expands as nests are built alongside or on top of existing ones. This parakeet has a long, green tail, an olive-green abdomen, and a gray-white face and throat. In some parts of South America, it is a serious agricultural pest.

Aratinga jandaya

Jandaya parakeet



Length 12 in (30 cm)
Weight 4 oz (125 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location E. South America



One of 30 species of conures, all found in eastern South America, this is a small parrot with a narrow, pointed tail. Its head and neck are yellow, gradually becoming orange-red on the breast and abdomen, and its back and wings are largely green. Usually encountered in noisy flocks of up to 15, this very active bird spends much of its time clambering among branches of trees or shrubs to find fruit. When disturbed, it swiftly takes flight while screeching loudly.



green back and wings

Anodorhynchus hyacinthinus

Hyacinth macaw

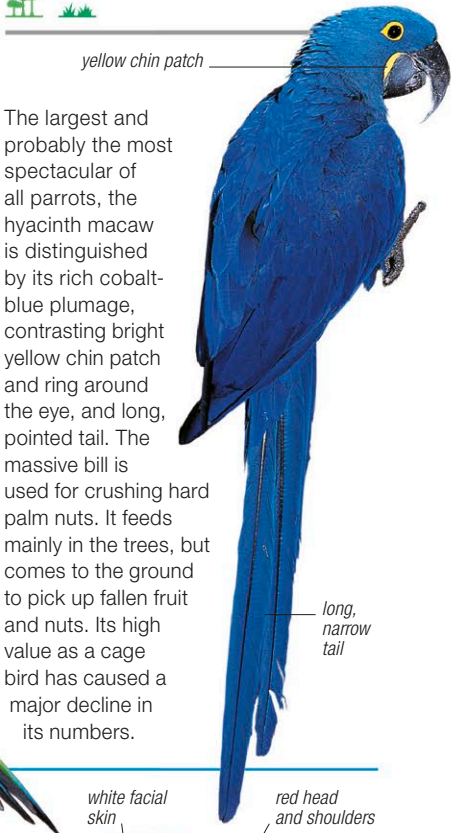


Length 3¼ ft (1 m)
Weight 3¼ lb (1.5 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Vulnerable

Location C. South America



The largest and probably the most spectacular of all parrots, the hyacinth macaw is distinguished by its rich cobalt-blue plumage, contrasting bright yellow chin patch and ring around the eye, and long, pointed tail. The massive bill is used for crushing hard palm nuts. It feeds mainly in the trees, but comes to the ground to pick up fallen fruit and nuts. Its high value as a cage bird has caused a major decline in its numbers.



yellow chin patch
long, narrow tail

Cyanopsitta spixii

Spix's macaw



Length 22 in (55 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Critically endangered

Location E. South America





BLUE PARROT
Spix's macaw has a long, pointed tail, and a silvery blue head, with dark gray skin surrounding the eyes. The back and wings are darker blue, and the bill is black.

CONSERVATION

Long one of the world's rarest birds, Spix's macaw vanished from the wild in 2000, when the last free-flying bird disappeared. Two main factors contributed to the species' decline: destruction of river-edge woodland—where it nests in a single species of tree—and the relentless wild-bird trade, which continued until only a handful of birds were left. Fortunately, a population had been built up in captivity, living in seminatural conditions in research stations and zoos. Raised since the 1980s, these now number nearly 100 birds. Captive breeding, together with habitat restoration and controls on illegal collecting, may one day be sufficient to reestablish the species in the wild.



Ara chloropterus

Red-and-green macaw



Length 35 in (90 cm)
Weight 2¼ lb (1 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location N. and C. South America



The red-and-green macaw attracts attention by its spectacular, vivid coloration and strident call. A large bird, like some other macaws it has a partly red plumage and a light blue back and rump. The long tail is tipped with blue. Its wings are blue with dark green upper-wing coverts, which give this species its name. The juveniles resemble adults, but have shorter tails. This macaw prefers humid, lowland forest, but in the southern part of its range, where the more common scarlet macaw (*Ara macao*) is absent, it frequents open habitats, including deciduous forest, and is often seen perching on the topmost projecting branches of tall trees. Usually encountered in pairs or small groups, possibly family groups, it sometimes associates with other, more



white facial skin
red head and shoulders
dark red plumage
dark green wing coverts

common, macaws, especially at earth banks, where large numbers gather to consume exposed mineral sands. In flight, red-and-green macaws call loudly to each other. This bird feeds on seeds, fruit, and nuts that are often larger or harder than those eaten by other macaws. Adult birds are killed for food or for feathers, while the chicks are taken from the nest for the live-bird trade.